Hypercarbic Respiratory Failure – Section Summary

COPD • Asthma • OHS

Critical Care Board Review • Section 10 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Key Points

- COPD: controlled O_2 (**Venturi**), most exacerbations = infection
- Asthma: **normal $PaCO_2$ = impending failure**; add ipratropium
- OHS → **BiPAP** (IPAP ~15)
- pH 7.24, $PaCO_2$ 70 → acute-on-chronic acidosis
- Lactic acidosis on continuous albuterol = treatment complication

2. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- [x] Normal $PaCO_2$ in asthma = danger
- [x] COPD → Venturi O_2

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